

Standard Operating Procedure

High-Risk Medication Dispensing and Recall Management

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.6.b, MOM.6.c, MOM.6.e (CORE, Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» dispenses high-risk medications only against a written order, manages near-expiry and beyond-expiry stock, and runs a recall when needed.

2. Scope

Applies to the pharmacy and every clinical area that dispenses medication.

3. Responsibility

Dispensing Pharmacist: verifies the written order for high-risk medications and manages recalls and expiry withdrawal.

4. Procedure

4.1 High-risk medication dispensing

1. Dispense a high-risk medication only against a written order — never on a verbal request alone.
2. A second staff member independently verifies the order and the medication before it is dispensed.

4.2 Near-expiry and beyond-expiry stock

1. Apply the hospital's defined 'near expiry' window and withdraw stock reaching it from active dispensing shelves.
2. Confirm no beyond-expiry medication is ever present in usable clinical stock — check at every stock count, not only when a discrepancy is suspected.

4.3 Recall management

1. On identifying a defective batch — internally or externally — withdraw it from all storage and dispensing points immediately.
2. Where the recall is internally identified, inform the appropriate regulatory authority.
3. Record every recall occurrence, including the batch, the trigger, and the withdrawal confirmation.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not dispense a high-risk medication without a written order and second-staff verification.

Do not allow beyond-expiry medication to remain in usable clinical stock — remove it the moment it is found, regardless of who finds it.

6. Records

Supported by Records 2, 3, and 5 of the MOM.6 Required Records pack.

7. Related Documents

- Policy on Safe Dispensing of Medications (HCO/MOM/POL/06) — MOM.6 policy
- SOP — Universal Medication Labelling (MOM.6.d)

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any recall or expiry-related near miss.